

Speaker 1 [00:00:07]: Ready, I think the recording has started now, and I'll share the screen to quickly show you the document. Can you see it?

Speaker 2 [00:00:22]: Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:00:23]: Okay, well, moving quickly, we explain that we are conducting an exploratory study called "A Multicultural Investigation on the Conceptualization and Measurement of Quality Monitoring." And here below, if you agree to participate, the interview should last about 40 minutes. It's completely voluntary. You can end the interview at any time if you don't want to participate anymore. And here below, moving quickly, we leave it to be checked. I give my consent for the audio of the interview to be recorded, which you've already given me, and that's why I'm recording. And here below, we explain how the data will be shared. Basically, there are two options. I agree with how the data will be shared. You can even change this option at the end of the interview if you want. The first option is the complete transcription. We transcribe everything that was said here, except for sensitive information, which can be shared. Then, after the interview, you can identify which sensitive information that will be. Or the second option here. The transcribed excerpts can be shared, as long as you are not identified in either case, which is not specified, but in both options, you remain anonymous. The only real difference is that the first option allows you not to permit the transcription of sensitive information. The rest, and the second option, is a complete transcription. So, you can tell me if you have a preference or if you want to give another option. You can also choose if you prefer another way.

Speaker 2 [00:02:01]: I think it can be the first phase. Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:02:07]: Okay. Complete transcription except for sensitive information. Then after the interview, I'll send you this document because I need you to sign it here, your signature, and mark the options you mentioned to me, to give consent and the option of the data you preferred. I need that saved and registered, and you can send it back to me by email. You send it back to me with that marked and signed. Is that okay?

Speaker 2 [00:02:38]: Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:02:39]: Okay, I'll stop sharing here, and we can start the interview. So, the first questions here are more about you. They are basic questions, right? How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:02:56]: I am [20-25].

Speaker 1 [00:02:58]: [20-25]. How long have you and your partner been together?

Speaker 2 [00:03:03]: [1-5] years, [1-5] months, and a few days.

Speaker 1 [00:03:08]: Do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:03:10]: No.

Speaker 1 [00:03:12]: Who do you live with?

Speaker 2 [00:03:14]: I live with my [family member], my [family member], and [1-5] siblings.

Speaker 1 [00:03:20]: What is your main source of income, and what is your current profession?

Speaker 2 [00:03:24]: I am an [occupation], and my main source of income is the [occupation] allowance. My profession is still a [occupation]. I'm [occupation] in the area of...

Speaker 1 [00:03:38]: Got it. Well, before starting the questions about you and [Partner's Name], I wanted to ask how you would like me to refer to her. Can it be partner, girlfriend, her name, companion?

Speaker 2 [00:03:53]: It can be any of those.

Speaker 1 [00:03:56]: Okay. The first question about this part, can you tell me more or less how your love story was? Remember that you can tell me as many details as you want. The more, the better, okay? So no need to summarize or anything.

Speaker 2 [00:04:17]: We met at a random party. It was last minute. She said she was going to leave too, but then she decided to go. We met at this party and exchanged phone numbers. It was gradual, you know? We started talking, meeting up, and a little after this party, I invited her to my place for a celebration, and she came. We weren't dating yet, we had only known each other for a few days. Shortly after, it was her birthday, and I went to her party at her house, met her relatives. We got to know each other, got closer, and I started falling for her, for how she treated people, for her commitment. After about [1-5] months, we started dating. Now I'm in love with her.

Speaker 1 [00:05:36]: Cool. How would you compare the quality of your relationship to that of your friends' relationships in general?

Speaker 2 [00:05:48]: I see that many of my friends have a lot of fights in their relationships due to lack of communication, which is something I don't have with [Partner's Name]. One of the things we value most in our relationship is sitting down and talking to address issues, to talk about what bothers us, what we like and don't like. I think that adds quality to our relationship. Because communication is the main point of everything. Without communication, there is no understanding in a relationship, which I see my friends lack, and it wears people out.

Speaker 1 [00:06:31]: So, you would say that dialogue is very important for you and her in the relationship? Understood. And do you mind telling me how many romantic partners you've had?

Speaker 2 [00:06:45]: I've had... [1-5], [1-5].

Speaker 1 [00:06:52]: Okay, [1-5] before her. How would you compare the quality of your current relationship with her to your previous relationships and why?

Speaker 2 [00:07:05]: With her, I have a much better quality, both romantically and in terms of partnership. In previous relationships, I didn't have that. I was often just doing what the other person wanted, without considering what I liked. My last relationship was quite troubled, and I see that with [Partner's Name], I don't have that. The mutual interest, feeling loved and loving another person is nice too. Considering that my serious relationship was with her, it was when I discovered I was a lesbian. I didn't have a good experience in a heterosexual relationship. My previous relationship was very toxic, psychologically draining. Everything had to be his way. I don't have that with [Partner's Name]. For example, if something happens, like I have to leave because of my parents, my previous partner would have fought because I was leaving, but with her, there's no fight. We have trust, communication, and affection.

Speaker 1 [00:08:54]: I see. So, from what I understand, you feel a greater sense of freedom with her.

Speaker 2 [00:09:02]: Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:09:05]: What makes a relationship high quality and low quality for you?

Speaker 2 [00:09:12]: Feelings and trust. Trust is one of the biggest things, trusting that if you're feeling down, the other person will be there for you, and vice versa. Knowing you can count on that person at any moment. In a low-quality relationship, you don't have that trust or confidence. If a person lies to you, there's no foundation in the relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:10:13]: You mentioned dialogue and trust a lot. Can you explain more about how you can tell if a relationship has these important aspects?

Speaker 2 [00:10:30]: Trust...

Speaker 1 [00:10:33]: Can you give me a concrete example of this?

Speaker 2 [00:10:36]: It often happens when you share something personal with the other person, and they don't use it against you but help you instead. Or there's the issue of being secretive with phones, as if something is being hidden. Trusting someone with your secrets and anxieties and knowing they'll help you.

Speaker 1 [00:11:10]: Can you give an example from your relationship, where trust was or wasn't present?

Speaker 2 [00:11:14]: With trust, there was a time we went to a party, and she took care of my phone and me, showing she trusts me. I know I can talk to her without feeling judged or thinking she's being unfaithful.

Speaker 1 [00:12:09]: What is most important to you in a relationship and why?

Speaker 2 [00:12:15]: Trust, dialogue, and respect for each other's boundaries. You can't grow together without these.

Speaker 1 [00:12:48]: What does love mean to you?

Speaker 2 [00:12:57]: Love is light. It's hard to explain but it's a great feeling, knowing you want to include that person in everything. For me, love means always thinking about the other person and wanting them to be part of your life.

Speaker 1 [00:13:46]: How important is love in a relationship for you?

Speaker 2 [00:13:53]: Very important. Without love, you don't feel good, leading to fights and an unhealthy relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:14:16]: How do you know your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:14:23]: By the way she takes care of me, her attentiveness, and how she interacts with me and others.

Speaker 1 [00:15:13]: Regarding conflicts in the relationship, what challenges do you face?

Speaker 2 [00:15:23]: We've never really had significant conflicts. I'm very calm and prefer to talk things out later when we're both calm.

Speaker 1 [00:15:47]: Aside from avoiding conflicts, do you see any other challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:16:08]: I'm very shy and have trouble opening up, which I'm working on. I've been improving in communicating my needs and feelings.

Speaker 1 [00:16:54]: Besides waiting to talk when calm, do you have other strategies to maintain your relationship, considering your communication difficulties?

Speaker 2 [00:17:12]: We try to explain how we feel and sometimes take time alone to think. She often asks what I want to do to help make decisions.

Speaker 1 [00:17:42]: Do you think having a relationship is good for you, and why?

Speaker 2 [00:18:07]: Yes, it's my best relationship. I don't feel afraid to express myself or worry about conflicts like I did in the past.

Speaker 1 [00:18:53]: Has your relationship changed you in any way? How?

Speaker 2 [00:18:59]: I'm more communicative, understanding my wants and needs better, and taking better care of myself and others.

Speaker 1 [00:20:02]: Do you think your partner has changed too during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:20:10]: Yes, she has improved in communication and balancing her own needs and the relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:21:02]: Hold on, say something because your voice wasn't clear at the end. Also, my dad is arriving home, and the dogs might start barking. Let me know if that happens. Do you feel secure in your relationship, and what makes you feel secure?

Speaker 2 [00:21:40]: Her actions, her care and attention, and creating a safe environment make me feel secure.

Speaker 1 [00:22:33]: Can you give a concrete example of feeling secure with her?

Speaker 2 [00:22:43]: When my grandmother passed away, she supported and comforted me, showing she was there for me physically and emotionally.

Speaker 1 [00:23:34]: Would you say physical contact is important in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:23:39]: Yes, very important.

Speaker 1 [00:24:00]: Now I'll share the screen again to show you a scale for some questions. Can you see it?

Speaker 2 [00:24:06]: Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:24:08]: This statement says, "My partner really listens to me." Please rate it from 1 (not true at all) to 9 (completely true). What number would you choose?

Speaker 2 [00:24:27]: I would choose 9.

Speaker 1 [00:24:29]: Similarly, "My partner cares about my needs." From 1 (not true at all) to 9 (completely true), what number would you choose?

Speaker 2 [00:24:42]: 9.

Speaker 1 [00:24:45]: Can you explain why you chose 9 for the first statement?

Speaker 2 [00:24:51]: Because she remembers things I mentioned before and brings them up later, showing she listens and cares about my preferences.

Speaker 1 [00:25:36]: And why did you choose 9 for the second statement?

Speaker 2 [00:25:51]: She always checks if I'm comfortable in social situations and adjusts to make sure I'm okay.

Speaker 1 [00:26:37]: I'll stop sharing the screen now, but I'll have to come back to it shortly for another set of questions. There are only two questions regarding your physical intimacy. Do you feel comfortable answering them? Have you had sexual relations lately?

Speaker 2 [00:27:08]: Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:27:11]: How satisfied are you with your sex life and why?

Speaker 2 [00:27:16]: I feel satisfied because we communicate well and respect each other's comfort and desires.

Speaker 1 [00:27:43]: I see. Now I'll share the screen again for a quick set of questions.

Speaker 2 [00:27:57]: Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:28:01]: How satisfied are you with your relationship in general? Please indicate a number from 1 (not at all) to 9 (completely).

Speaker 2 [00:28:17]: Completely satisfied but open to improvement. We live together.

Speaker 1 [00:28:27]: So, you chose completely satisfied. Can you give a more precise number for your satisfaction?

Speaker 2 [00:28:54]: I think 9. There is still a lot for us to experience together.

Speaker 1 [00:29:20]: Can you explain why you chose 9 instead of 10 or another number?

Speaker 2 [00:29:40]: Because we are still new in the relationship. There's a lot to explore and experience, especially regarding physical closeness.

Speaker 1 [00:30:16]: I'm wrapping up the interview. You mentioned the importance of dialogue, trust, care, attention, affection, and freedom. Is there anything else you would like to add?

Speaker 2 [00:30:59]: No, that's it.

Speaker 1 [00:31:09]: Okay, [Name], thank you for participating. As I mentioned, I'll ask again about the options for storing your information. You can keep the same choice or change it now.

Speaker 2 [00:31:37]: It was all fine for me, nothing too sensitive. You can use everything as needed.

Speaker 1 [00:31:50]: Okay. I'll send you the document by email. Please mark your preferred option and sign it. Thank you again for participating. This research is happening in the Philippines, Brazil, the Netherlands, France, and the United States. We are still gathering data, so if you could help with one more thing, I need a recommendation. Can you suggest one or two people who know an LGBT non-monogamous couple?

Speaker 2 [00:32:58]: Yes, I think there's someone at my college. I can message them.

Speaker 1 [00:33:08]: You can send it via [Social Media].

Speaker 2 [00:33:11]: Sure, I'll talk to them.

Speaker 1 [00:33:43]: Great, please let them know I might contact them. Thank you, [Participant's Name]. I'll email you the document and then interview [Partner's Name]. Good luck with the rest of your research.

Speaker 2 [00:34:03]: Thank you.

Speaker 1 [00:34:05]: Thank you.

Speaker 2 [00:34:15]: Good luck with your research.

Speaker 1 [00:34:17]: Thank you very much.

Speaker 2 [00:34:19]: Thank you.

Speaker 1 [00:34:24]: Bye, [Participant's Name].

Speaker 2 [00:34:24]: Bye.